

to keep the most amazing parts of their lives a complete secret from those they hold closest and dearest (short of enchantment, which carries its own problems). Kinain and their parents do not have to worry about this. A Kinain doesn't necessarily have to lie when his parents ask what he did after school, or what his friends are like. A changeling with a Kinain child doesn't have to avoid awkward questions and come up with Banality-inducing excuses for where she goes all the time.

The advantage of being raised in an environment where faeries and the Dreaming are considered completely normal obviously doesn't apply if the Kinain in question isn't raised by at least one changeling parent. Adoption, marriage, or simply Banality doing its twisted work can all create such a situation.

Such orphaned Kinain are treated much like changelings that emerge from their Chrysalis at a very young age. Without the innate understanding of what it is they see or experience, orphaned Kinain are harder to bring into the fold than a changeling, who awakens from her metaphysical slumber with some idea of what she is and what is happening.

The usual strategy for introducing an orphaned Kinain is slowly introducing her to the supernatural, creating small encounters with the supernatural that start to build up and allowing her to come to her own conclusions. Even better if someone from the local freehold can make friends with her, acting as something of a guide and mentor. This is usually tied to her heritage for maximum effect. The child of a troll might be directed toward chimerical beasts of increasing impossibility to slay. A sidhe's son might be asked for advice and leadership by a younger motley, who slowly let on to their true nature. A pooka's daughter has harmless, yet obviously magical pranks played on her until she turns the tricks back on her new friends. This can backfire if her personality diverges greatly from her heritage, but is usually at least partway effective.

Should things be direr, subtlety may be thrown out the window entirely. A rival freehold might be courting her as well, or the forces of Winter may conspire to snuff out her ember of the Dreaming before the Kithain can spark a fire. In such cases, expediency is preferred over what is healthy for the orphaned one, who is rushed into the world of the fae whether they like it or not. The disadvantage to this approach is obvious, though the problems it creates can usually be smoothed over later, or ignored by changelings callous enough.

Kinain as Antagonists

The rejection of the Dreaming is not limited to pure changelings or pure mortals. Kinain are every bit as capable of rejecting their heritage or being exceptionally Banal as their parents, with similar results. Kinain, then, exist among the ranks of both the Dauntain and the Autumn People, and are equally dangerous no matter which side of the line they stand on.

Dauntain cannot twist the Kinain's souls into the wretched things they possess, but their minds are another thing entirely. The Dauntain such a Fae-Blooded serves is usually one of her parents or close relatives, but some particularly malicious Dauntain have been known to assemble cults that can carry out their plans for the Dreaming.

The Autumn Kinain are just what they sound like — Autumn People that happen to be fae-blooded. The Dreaming infusing itself into someone from birth in no way prevents that person from being exceptionally boring to be around. A terribly serious or mundane person is always a problem, but the sad truth is that most times he isn't malicious — it's just a fact to him that wonder and imagination are wastes of time, that weight should be put in what's "real." To an Autumn Kinain, he's acting completely normal. He might even buy into the Bellerophon Group's propaganda and try to get himself treated for PFD, or worse, surprise his changeling family with an "intervention" staged by the Autumn Kinain's new friends at Bellerophon. Even if he's not proactive with his endorsement of Banality, he radiates it just as much as he does Glamour, making him dangerous to even be around, as painful as that must be for his loved ones. Such Kinain are best not brought anywhere near a freehold or introduced to their family's fae friends. Even if his immediate family is willing to risk Banality for the sake of family, other changelings may disagree, especially in the nobility.

The Winter Kinain are more dangerous to be around, and even a greater threat than the Kithain they emulate. They're the ultimate worst-case scenario for a Kinain, one who looks at the Dreaming, the Kithain, and themselves, and recoils in horror and revulsion. Winter Kinain are living founts of the Autumn World's most banal qualities, and with their self-replenishing Glamour stores, they never burn themselves out and wind up Undone. Naturally, this represents one of the greatest individual threats to the Dreaming, and once a Kinain is identified as having fallen to Winter, it's not uncommon for even the greatest of rivals to call a truce to put down the greater threat.

Kinain Mechanics

The following are rules for playing and creating Kinain characters.

Glamour Regeneration

Kinain are, body and soul, a fusion of faerie and human. This grants them no harvesting capabilities, but instead the remarkable power to regenerate a small supply of Glamour from their own emotions. All Kinain can store up to 2 points of Glamour, and regenerate 1 point per chapter up to that maximum. Changelings can Ravage Kinain as they would any other mortal.

Heritage

Rather than kith, Kinain have a *heritage*. This is the kith of her faerie parent, from which she draws her fae power. In the case of both parents being changelings, which heritage she displays varies, but one always comes to the fore. Any signs of the other parent's magic are limited to cosmetic attributes. Sometimes the dominant heritage is quickly made obvious through the Kinain's physical traits, subdued as they may be: A half-nocker looks different from a half-troll, and so on. It might instead be that the child doesn't show any obvious traits from her heritage, and it manifests in personality, instead. A completely average-looking boy or girl winds up fascinated with taking things apart or breaking them, or ordering her peers (and elders) around, and then her heritage is clear.